

— FOR THE HARD DAYS

Don't plan the whole day. *Plan the next 10 minutes.*

A survival ladder for anyone going back into a workplace that hurts.

One rung at a time

10 min	Breathe. Drink some water. Step outside if you can.
20 min	Write down what happened: the date, the time, the exact words, and who was there.
30 min	Text one safe person. “Rough day, just need you to know.”
60 min	Do one thing that belongs to you: music, a walk, the cat.
Then	Choose one more day. Just one.

KEEP YOUR OWN RECORD

It isn't paranoia. It's the file they won't give you.

DATE & TIME

WHO

EXACT WORDS

WITNESSES

HOW IT AFFECTED MY WORK

WHO I TOLD

The organization keeps a file on you. Your notes are the only record of your side.



I go back tomorrow. I'm scared.

I'm also better informed than I've ever been. Fear and preparation can ride in the same car.

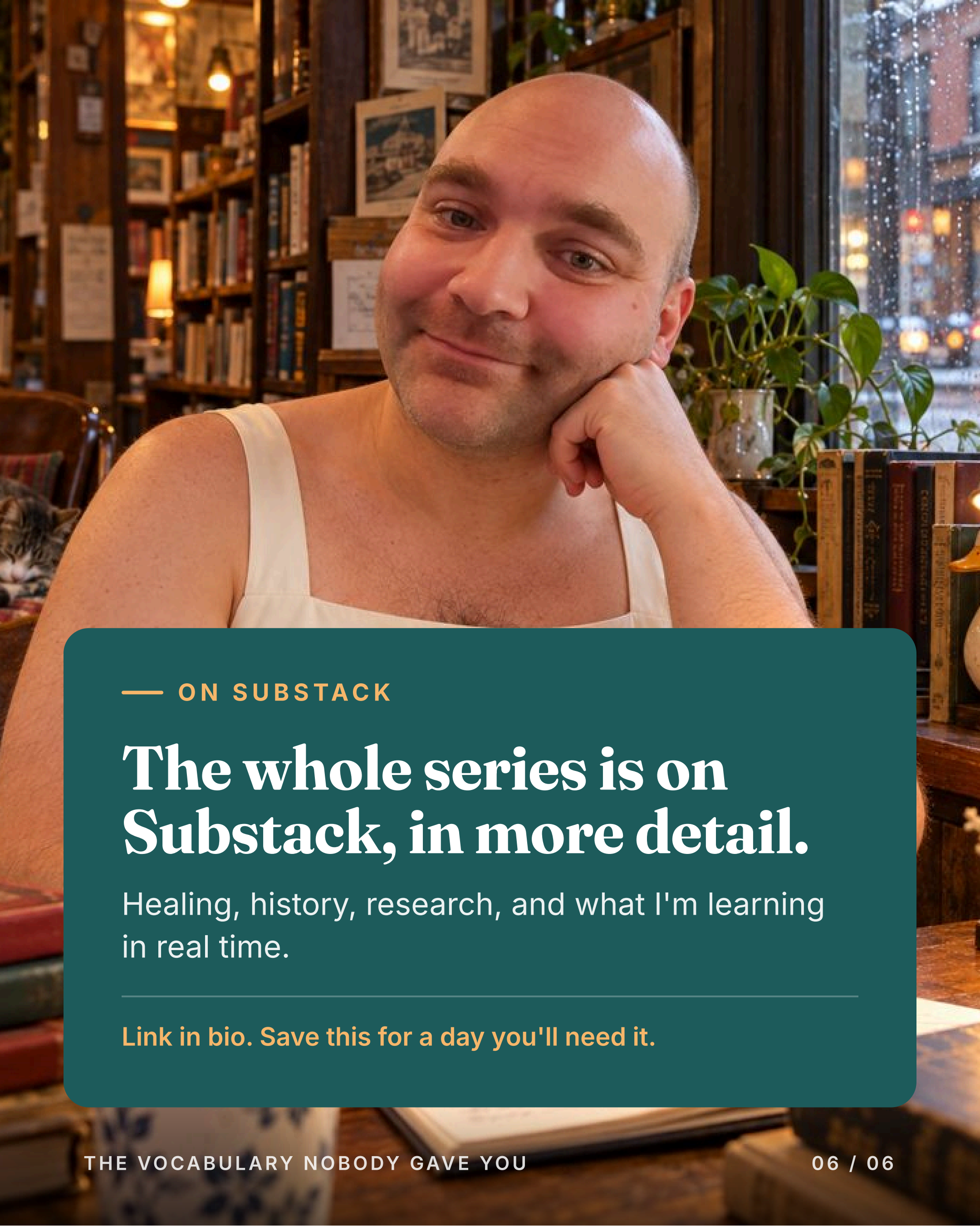
YOU ARE NOT ALONE

If you're still going, tell me.

Comment **“here”** so the next person who reads this can see they aren't the only one.

If you're in crisis in the US, call or text **988**.
Outside the US, look up your local crisis line.

Next 10 minutes. Then the next.



— ON SUBSTACK

The whole series is on Substack, in more detail.

Healing, history, research, and what I'm learning in real time.

Link in bio. Save this for a day you'll need it.